

CONFLICT



-NILAM SANGROULA



AGENDA

- Concept
- Types of Conflicts
- Approaches to Conflict Management
- Resolving Conflicts

Concept of Conflict

Conflict is the outcome of behavioral interactions. It consists of all kinds of opposition or antagonistic interactions. It is inevitable in groups and organization.

According to Newstrom and Davis: Conflict is any situation in which two or more parties feel themselves in opposition.

According to Stephen P. Robbins: Conflict is a process that begins when one party perceives that another party has negatively affected, or is about to negatively affect, something that the first party cares about.



Conflict Process

The conflict process comprises of five stages:

Incompatibility (Stage I)

Cognition and Personalization (Stage II)

Intentions (Stage III)

Behavior (Stage IV)

Outcomes (Stage V)





Stage I: Incompatibility or Potential Opposition The first stage of conflict is the appearance of conditions—causes or sources—that create opportunities for it to arise. These conditions *need not* lead directly to conflict, but one of them is necessary if it is to surface. We group the conditions into three general categories:

- A) Communication: Conflict can arise from semantic issues, misunderstanding, or noise in the communication channel that hasn't been clarified. For instance, your new manager, Nilam, is leading a project and you're on the team. Nilam is vague about the team's goals, and when you get to work on your part of the project, Nilam shows up half the way through to tell you you're doing it wrong. This is conflict caused by communication.

B) Group Structure: Conflict can arise based on the structure of a group of people who have to work together. For instance, let's say you sell cars, and your co-worker has to approve the credit of all the people who purchase a vehicle from you. If your co-worker doesn't approve your customers, then he is standing between you and your commission, your good performance review, and your paycheck. This is a structure that invites conflict. They can be:

- ❖ Size
- ❖ Task specialization
- ❖ Jurisdiction clarity
- ❖ Leadership style
- ❖ Reward system etc.

+



Personal variables:

Conflict can arise if two people who work together just don't care for each other. Perhaps you work with a man and you find him untrustworthy.

Comments he's made, the way he laughs, the way he talks about his wife and family, all of it just rubs you the wrong way. That's personal variable, ripe to cause a conflict.



Stage II: Cognition and Personalization

The incompatibilities get actualized in this stage

- ❖ One or more parties should perceive conflict
- ❖ Perceived conflict is awareness by one or more parties of incompatibilities that create conflict
- ❖ The conflict should be personalized or felt (Anxiety, tension, frustration or hostility)
- ❖ The parties define what the conflict is about



Stage III: Intentions

Intentions are decisions to act in a given way: they can be

Competing. One party seeks to satisfy his own interests regardless of the impact on the other party.

Collaborating. One party, or both, desire to fully satisfied the concerns of all parties involved in the conflict.

Avoiding. One party withdraws from or suppresses the conflict once it is recognized.

Accommodating. One party seeks to appease the opponent once potential conflict is recognized.

Compromising. Each party to the conflict seeks to give up something to resolve the conflict.



Stage IV: Behavior

Behavior is the stage where conflict becomes evident, as it includes the statements, actions and reactions of the parties involved in the conflict. These behaviors might be overt attempts to get the other party to reveal intentions, but they have a stimulus quality that separates them from the actual intention stage.

Behavior is the actual dynamic process of interaction. Perhaps Party A makes a demand on Party B, Party B argues back, Party A threatens, and so on. The intensity of the behavior falls along a conflict oriented continuum. If the intensity is low, the conflict might just be a minor misunderstanding, and if the intensity is high, the conflict could be an effort to harm or even destroy the other party.



Stage V: Outcomes

Outcomes of a conflict can be either functional or dysfunctional:

Functional outcomes occur when conflict is constructive. It may be hard to think of times when people disagree and argue, and the outcome is somehow good.

- ❖ Improves quality of decisions
- ❖ Stimulates creativity and innovation
- ❖ Encourage interest and curiosity among group members
- ❖ Airs problems and release tensions
- ❖ Fosters environment of self evaluation and change



Dysfunctional outcomes are generally more well known and understood. Uncontrolled opposition breeds discontent, which acts to sever ties and eventually leads to the dissolution of the group.

- ❖ Breeds discontent
- ❖ Retards communication
- ❖ Reduces group cohesiveness
- ❖ Promotes infighting between members
- ❖ Threatens group survival



Possible outcomes of conflicts

Lose-lose: Both parties are worse off

Lose-win: One party is better off: A compared to B

Win-lose: One party is better off: B compared to A

Win-win: Both parties are better off. This is the most preferred outcome.

Types of Conflicts



1. **Functional or Dysfunctional Conflict:**

Functional conflict is substantial and issue oriented. It is of constructive form. Supports the goal of the group and improves the performance.

Dysfunctional conflict is of personal nature. So it is personality oriented. It is based on animosities and deep rooted personal feelings and attitude.



2. Task , Process and Relationship Conflict:

Task Conflict:

- ❖ It relates to the content and goals of work. It can result from task interdependence, task ambiguity and difference in work orientation.
- ❖ A low to moderate level of task conflict is functional. It stimulates discussions of ideas and issues that help groups perform better.

Process Conflict:

- ❖ It relates to how the work gets done.
- ❖ A low level of process conflict is functional

Relationship Conflict:

- ❖ A conflict based on interpersonal relationship. It is dysfunctional to the organization. It hinders completion of

Approaches to Conflict Management

Structural Conflict Management Approaches

It has two aspects. They are

Conflict Stimulation techniques

Communication

Bringing in outsiders

Restructure the organization

Encouraging competition

Conflict Resolution Structural

Problem Solving

Super-ordinate goals

Expansion of resources

Avoidance

Smoothing

Compromise

Authoritative command

Altering the structural

variables

+

•



Traditional approach:

The traditional approach to conflict is the earliest view on organizational conflicts. It is the simplest approach for conflicts and was developed in the 1930s. In the past, the managers considered conflicts as evil, outright wrong, destructive, and negative. Furthermore, managers wanted to avoid conflicts completely at their workstation as conflicts bring demotivated workforce, less productivity, and dysfunctional work.



Modern approach:

The modern approach to conflicts is the contemporary view on organizational conflicts. The development and expansion of studies on organizational behavior and HR methodologies challenge certain traditional approaches.

The modern approach to conflict identifies conflicts as an important part of the organization. Moreover, it considers conflicts as favorable to the company and does not eliminate them at all. According to modern theories, if an organization does not face any conflicts, the organization is unadaptable, non-flexible, non-responsive, and

Resolution of Organizational Conflicts:

CONFLICT

+



Conflict resolution is the process by which two or more parties reach a peaceful resolution to a dispute.

- ❖ Handle the conflict positively.
- ❖ Formation of the official grievance procedure for all members.
- ❖ Concentrate on the causes rather than their effect, to assess conflicts.
- ❖ Parties to conflicts should be given an equal voice, irrespective of their position, term, or political influence.

CONFLICT

+



o



.



THANK YOU

QUESTIONS